

iAAi — Compensation Framework

For: Founding Volunteer Team | **Version:** 1.0 | **Date:** 25 April 2026 **Stage:** Pre-revenue, pre-funding | **Target raise:** \$800K for 10% equity (Year 1) **Governance:** Model B — Chairman holds Permanent Double Voting Power on 10-member board

The Situation — Honest and Direct

iAAi is pre-revenue and pre-funding. The \$800K seed raise has not closed. There is no salary budget today. The intellectual property is complete — 297-page manuscript, 757 validated data blocks, 933 iCards, 12 relays playable, live website — but the engineering team does not yet exist.

We are asking developers to volunteer their time to build a micro-prototype (30–60 second interactive demo) that will unlock the raise. This document explains what you receive in return, when you receive it, and how the structure protects your contribution.

Phase 1: Volunteer Period (Now → Raise Close)

During the volunteer period, there is no cash compensation. Contributors receive:

Equity allocation from the Founding Team Pool. A portion of the founder's equity is reserved for early contributors who join before the raise closes. The exact percentage per contributor depends on role, hours contributed, and impact on the prototype. The allocation is agreed in writing before work begins.

Role	Estimated Weekly Hours	Equity Range (from Founder Pool)
Game Developer / Interactive Engineer	8–12 hrs/week	0.5% – 1.5%
UI/UX Designer	6–10 hrs/week	0.3% – 1.0%
Backend / AI Integration Engineer	8–12 hrs/week	0.5% – 1.5%
Systems Designer / Content Engineer	6–10 hrs/week	0.3% – 1.0%

These ranges are starting points for negotiation, not fixed offers. A developer who ships the working prototype and stays through the raise will be at the top of the range. A contributor who participates part-time for a few weeks will be at the lower end. The principle is simple: **equity reflects contribution, not title.**

Vesting schedule: 12-month cliff, 36-month total vest, with acceleration on change of control (acquisition or IPO). If you leave before the 12-month cliff, unvested equity returns to the pool. This protects both sides — you are protected against being diluted out, and the project is protected against early departures.

Written agreement: Every contributor signs a simple Contributor Agreement before work begins. This covers: equity allocation, vesting terms, IP assignment (work product belongs to iAAi), confidentiality, and the right to credit as a founding team member. No work begins without this in place.

Phase 2: Post-Raise (After \$800K Closes)

Once the seed raise closes, the budget allocates as follows:

Phase	Months	Budget	Primary Use
1	M1–3	\$150,000	Knowledge transfer, stable system architecture
2	M4–6	\$200,000	MVP build, beta launch with 1,000 users
3	M7–9	\$250,000	China market entry via BRI mandate
4	M10–12	\$200,000	Scale, franchise model, Series A preparation

Founding team members who contributed during the volunteer phase transition to **paid roles** from the raise proceeds. Compensation post-raise follows a hybrid model:

Below-market salary + equity. The raise is \$800K for a 12-month runway across all operations (team, product, market entry). Individual salaries will be below market rate — this is a startup, not a corporation. The equity allocation from Phase 1 compensates for the salary gap. The combination of below-market salary plus founding equity is designed to be competitive with market rate when measured over a 3–5 year horizon, assuming the company hits its projected milestones.

Indicative post-raise compensation (annualised):

Role	Cash (Annual)	Equity (Already Vesting)	Total Value at FY29 EV (\$250M)
Game Developer	\$48,000 – \$72,000	0.5% – 1.5%	\$1.25M – \$3.75M
UI/UX Designer	\$36,000 – \$60,000	0.3% – 1.0%	\$750K – \$2.5M
Backend Engineer	\$48,000 – \$72,000	0.5% – 1.5%	\$1.25M – \$3.75M
Systems Designer	\$36,000 – \$60,000	0.3% – 1.0%	\$750K – \$2.5M

The “Total Value at FY29 EV” column is illustrative, not guaranteed. It shows what the equity would be worth if iAAi reaches its Year 3 projected enterprise value of \$250M (based on 25× EBITDA on \$10M EBITDA). The actual value depends entirely on execution.

Phase 3: Series A and Beyond

If the company reaches Series A (targeted M10–12 of Year 1), founding team equity is protected by standard anti-dilution provisions. The Model B governance structure means the Chairman (Nigel Dearden) holds permanent double voting power on the 10-member board — this protects the mission and the founding team’s vision from being overridden by later-stage investors.

Additional equity grants, salary increases, and performance bonuses become available at Series A. Founding team members who have been contributing since Phase 1 will have priority for senior roles as the company scales.

What This Means in Practice

If you join now and the raise closes in 6 months:

- You contribute 8–12 hours/week for ~6 months (roughly 200–300 hours)
- You receive 0.5%–1.5% equity with a 12-month cliff / 36-month vest
- You transition to a paid role at \$48K–\$72K/year plus your vesting equity
- If iAAi reaches its Year 3 EV projection, your equity is worth \$1.25M–\$3.75M
- If iAAi reaches its Year 5 EV projection (\$3.13B), your equity is worth \$15.6M–\$47M

If you join now and the raise does not close:

- You keep your equity allocation (it vests from the date of your Contributor Agreement)
- The equity has no liquid value until a funding event or exit
- You have no obligation to continue contributing
- You retain credit as a founding team member

This is the honest trade-off. The upside is significant. The risk is real. We are looking for people who understand both.

Governance and Protections

Protection	Detail
Written Contributor Agreement	Signed before any work begins
Equity vesting	12-month cliff, 36-month total, acceleration on exit
Anti-dilution	Standard provisions at Series A
IP clarity	All work product assigned to iAAi; contributor retains portfolio rights
Credit	Permanent recognition as founding team member
Model B governance	Chairman's double voting power protects mission alignment
Board representation	Founding team members eligible for board observer seats

A Note on Values

This framework is designed for builders, not speculators. We are not offering lottery tickets. We are offering a seat at the table of a category-creating platform backed by 120,000 hours of lived infrastructure experience and a complete intellectual property portfolio.

The people who built the early internet did not do it for the salary. They did it because they saw what it could become. Infrastructure education is a \$0 market today. It will not be a \$0 market in five years. The question is whether you want to be the person who built it, or the person who watched someone else build it.

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